



Emotional development is about feelings – children feeling good about themselves and having good self-esteem. It is about children knowing where they belong and who they are – having a strong sense of identity. *For example, sharing in enjoyable play activities and developing their skills encourage children's confidence and their sense of achievement.*

The emotional domain includes a child's growing understanding and control of their emotions. They also begin to identify what others are feeling, develop the ability to cooperate, show empathy, and use moral reasoning.

This includes **developing attachments to others** and **learning how to interact with them**. For instance, children learn how to **share, take turns, and accept differences in others**. They also develop many different types of **relationships**, from parents and siblings to peers, teachers, coaches, and others in the community. Children develop self-knowledge during the emotional stage. They learn how they **identify with different groups** and their **innate temperament** will emerge in their relationships.

To help a child develop emotionally, look for opportunities for them to **interact with kids** their age and help them **form relationships with both children and adults**. You can arrange

playdates, explore playgroups, and look into extracurricular activities. Also encourage them to **talk to their grandparents, teachers, and coaches** as well.

To encourage a **sense of self**, ask your child about their **interests** and **passions** and encourage them to **identify their strengths and weaknesses**. Teach them about **recognizing** and **managing** feelings. As they get older, talk to them about **healthy friendships** and how to **handle peer pressure**.

You also should not shy away from the **challenging talks** like those covering **sex** and **consent**. All of these different social and emotional facets play into your child's overall development.

COGNITIVE DEVELOPMENT



Cognitive development is about how children use their brain for activities – how children learn how to think. Cognitive development includes thinking, problem solving, pretending, creativity, learning and understanding. The cognitive domain includes **intellectual development** and **creativity**. As they develop cognitively, kids gain the ability to **process thoughts, pay attention, develop memories, understand their surroundings, express creativity**, as well as to **make, implement, and accomplish plans**.

The child psychologist Jean Piaget outlined four stages of cognitive development:

- **Sensorimotor Stage (Birth to Age 2)**

This stage involves learning about the environment through movements and sensations. Infants and toddlers use basic actions like sucking, grasping, looking, and listening to learn about the world around them.

- **Preoperational Stage (Ages 2 to 7)**

During this stage, children learn to think symbolically as well as use words or pictures to represent things. Kids in this stage enjoy pretend play, but still struggle with logic and understanding another person's perspective.

- **Concrete Operational Stage (Ages 7 to 11)**

Once they enter this stage, kids start to think more logically, but may still struggle with hypothetical situations and abstract thinking. Because they are beginning to see things from another person's perspective, now is a good time to start teaching empathy.

- **Formal Operational Stage (Age 12 and Up)**

During this stage, a child develops an increase in logical thinking. They also develop an ability to use deductive reasoning and understand abstract ideas. As they become more adept at problem-solving, they also are able to think more scientifically about the world around them.

You can help your child develop and hone their cognitive skills by giving them opportunities to play with blocks, puzzles, and board games. You also should create an environment where your child feels comfortable asking questions about the world around them and has plenty of opportunities for free play.

Develop your child's desire to learn by helping them explore topics they are passionate about. Encourage thinking and reasoning skills by asking them open-ended questions and teaching them to expand on their thought processes. As they get older, teach them how to be critical consumers of media and where to find answers to things they don't know.